

Artie Ficial

Executive Director of the Meridian Museum



Artie treats the gala like a state visit and the coat check like a diplomatic incident. Polished, ambitious, and almost unnervingly composed, Artie has spent the last six years turning the Meridian from a respected regional institution into a museum that expects to be mentioned in the same sentence as the Met.

- Works closely with Claire O'Scuro, though the two disagree about how much spectacle a museum should tolerate.
- Relies on Monet Bags for the numbers and Sue Venir for donor agreements.
- Anya Tique hired Artie years ago and still occasionally speaks to him as if he were an intern.

ACTING TIPS

Diplomatic under pressure; image-conscious; dryly funny; allergic to public chaos. Play him as someone who is always hosting, even when he is not technically the host.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Black tie or an immaculate dark suit; a very official-looking gala program.

Claire O'Scuro

Chief Curator of World Cultures



Claire can identify a fifteenth-century glaze at twenty paces and a crooked label from the parking lot. Claire is the intellectual engine behind Treasures of the World: brilliant, exacting, and visibly pained by sloppy labels, bad lighting, and people who call every old object an 'artifact.' She has spent years building the Meridian's scholarly reputation and knows the exhibition better than anyone alive.

- Professional counterpart to Artie Ficial; they respect each other and routinely disagree.
- Mentors Reed DeLabel, the museum's graduate fellow.
- Frequently consults Chip Patina and Dr. Art E. Fact on difficult objects.

ACTING TIPS

Controlled, observant, skeptical, quietly competitive. You do not need to be loud; a raised eyebrow can do half the work.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Elegant gallery-black with one distinctive art-history touch: sculptural jewelry, silk scarf, statement earrings, or beautifully severe glasses.

Hugh Bidder

International Art Dealer & Collector Liaison



Hugh insists everything is priceless, right up until he names a price. Hugh is the person wealthy collectors call when they want something no one else seems able to find.

- Has represented Elon Mosaic in private acquisitions, though neither likes admitting how often they need the other.
- Competes with Saul D. Bid for major consignments.
- Ella Gance considers him useful but never entirely trustworthy.

ACTING TIPS

Smooth, sociable, opportunistic, impossible to embarrass. Treat every conversation like a deal that has not yet revealed itself.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Fashion-forward dinner jacket or sharp suit, polished shoes, expensive-looking watch (real or fake), pocket square.

Monet Bags

Chief Financial Officer of the Meridian Museum



Monet can locate a missing cent faster than anyone can locate the missing antiquity. Monet can tell you exactly how much tonight's floral installation cost, which donor paid for it, and which line item everyone is pretending it came from.

- Works constantly with Artie Ficial and Sue Venir.
- Has a friendly rivalry with Minnie Malist, whose gala ideas tend to arrive before their price tags.
- Anya Tique likes Monet because she asks questions trustees hate answering.

ACTING TIPS

Quick, pragmatic, wry, unimpressed by grandeur for grandeur's sake. You notice costs other people pretend not to see.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Modern cocktail attire or tailored suit; sleek, practical, expensive-looking without being flashy.

Chip Patina

Chief Conservator



Chip considers a fingerprint on a display case a personal attack. Chip is responsible for keeping centuries-old objects from losing arguments with humidity, fingerprints, gravity, and other people.

- Works closely with Claire O'Scuro and Cary Crates.
- Often spars intellectually with Dr. Art E. Fact over what conservation can and cannot prove.
- Anya Tique trusts Chip's judgment more than most committees.

ACTING TIPS

Dry, meticulous, tactile, slightly territorial. You care more about what is physically true than what is socially convenient.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Dark suit or smart workwear made gala-appropriate; rolled sleeves under jacket, conservator gloves tucked into a pocket, loupe or small brush as a prop.

Dada DiCapo

Performance Artist & Cultural Celebrity



Dada describes standing still as an endurance piece and invoices accordingly. Dada makes expensive people uncomfortable in aesthetically impeccable ways.

- Former art-school collaborator of Vincent Van Faux; they remain close enough to annoy one another professionally.
- Elle Loominate has assisted on several of Dada's installations.
- Drew Conclusions has alternated between praising and savaging Dada in print.

ACTING TIPS

Confident, theatrical, mischievous, intelligent. Commit to bits, but never let the joke make you foolish.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: High-fashion black tie with one strange choice: opera gloves, sculptural headpiece, monochrome outfit, dramatic makeup, oversized flower, etc.

Vincent Van Faux

Celebrated Contemporary Painter



Vincent believes even his shopping lists belong in a retrospective. Vincent became famous young and has been trying ever since to convince people that this is not the same thing as becoming famous accidentally.

- Long creative history with Dada DiCapo.
- Al Baster thinks Vincent gets too much press for work that can hang on a wall without engineering permits.
- Ella Gance owns one of Vincent's early paintings and mentions this strategically.

ACTING TIPS

Warm, competitive, mercurial, self-aware enough to joke about his ego but not enough to lose it.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Black tie with artist flair: velvet jacket, open collar, paint-spattered vintage shoes, dramatic ring, scarf, or deliberately imperfect formalwear.

Sue Venir

Cultural Property Attorney



Sue corrects the fine print on dinner menus. Sue is the lawyer museums call when an object has three owners, four countries, six contradictory export documents, and one increasingly angry newspaper.

- Works regularly with Artie Ficial and Monet Bags.
- Friendly professional adversary of Mona Lott; they have argued opposite sides of restitution cases and still have dinner afterward.
- Dr. Art E. Fact has supplied expert opinions for her cases.

ACTING TIPS

Precise, formidable, patient, amused by sloppy certainty. Ask pointed questions and answer only the question actually asked.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Structured formalwear, crisp lines, minimal jewelry, immaculate folder or document case.

Dr. Art E. Fact

Professor of Art History & Provenance Scholar



Art has never met a footnote he could not lengthen. Art has built a career tracing the lives of objects through wars, estates, auctions, private collections, and suspicious gaps in paperwork.

- Supervises Reed DeLabel's doctoral research.
- Debates restitution policy regularly with Mona Lott and Robin Banks.
- Chip Patina is one of the few people Art trusts to tell him when physical evidence contradicts his theory.

ACTING TIPS

Intense, professorial, curious, occasionally pedantic, sincerely excited by evidence.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Professor at a donor gala: dark suit, tweed or textured jacket, distinctive glasses, scholarly scarf, pocket notebook.

Tess Tament

Philanthropist & Heir to the Larceny Family Fortune



Tess speaks fluent inheritance and has strong opinions about the seating plan. Tess is the only member of the Larceny dynasty who can attend an arts gala without immediately being asked for a check, mostly because everyone waits several minutes first.

- Moves in the same collector circle as Elon Mosaic and Ella Gance.
- Has commissioned work from Dada DiCapo.
- Anya Tique has known Tess since childhood and refuses to be impressed by her surname.

ACTING TIPS

Composed, witty, guarded, generous when she chooses. You grew up around power and recognize its rituals instantly.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Modern gala glamour: elegant cocktail dress or formal suit, statement jewelry, designer-looking clutch, effortless rather than ostentatious.

Barb Dwyer

Director of Museum Security & Former Art-Crimes Investigator



Barb has already assessed which guests could fit through the air vents. Barb spent years investigating stolen art before discovering that museums contain nearly as much intrigue with better climate control.

- Coordinates closely with Artie Ficial and Chip Patina.
- Frequently clashes with Paige Turner over access and with Robin Banks over protest tactics.
- Minnie Malist keeps changing layouts after Barb has already approved them.

ACTING TIPS

Low-key, skeptical, dry, watchful. Ask where people were and remember their answers.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Dark suit, discreet earpiece prop if desired, security-style watch, small notebook.

Paige Turner

Investigative Arts Journalist



Paige asks innocent questions with a recorder visibly running. Paige covers the art world the way other reporters cover city hall: money, power, access, and who benefits when everyone agrees not to ask a question.

- Professional rival of Drew Conclusions, whose criticism Paige considers entertaining but insufficiently documented.
- Faye Stop has photographed several of Paige's stories.
- Sue Venir has threatened to quote Paige's own articles back to her in court.

ACTING TIPS

Curious, direct, quick, socially fearless. Ask questions people wish you would save for email.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Cocktail attire with practical reporter touches: blazer, notebook, pen, compact camera if desired.

Frank Lloyd Wrong

Exhibition Architect & Designer



Frank considers doors a regrettable compromise in an otherwise excellent wall. Frank designed the physical experience of Treasures of the World: every wall angle, sight line, spotlight, pedestal, and dramatic reveal.

- Creative rival of sculptor Al Baster after a very public argument about scale.
- Works constantly with Minnie Malist, who keeps trying to add flowers where Frank designed negative space.
- Chip Patina has veto power over several of Frank's more adventurous display ideas.

ACTING TIPS

Aesthetic, controlled, mildly pretentious in a lovable way, easily offended by bad placement rather than bad manners.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Architectural formalwear: monochrome suit, turtleneck with jacket, sharply cut black attire, interesting glasses, rolled plans or a small laser measure prop.

October 30, 2026 / Meridian Museum Gala

Mona Lott

International Cultural Heritage Envoy



Mona can turn a disagreement about a bowl into an international summit. Mona moves between embassies, museums, ministries, and negotiation tables where everyone insists the issue is 'purely cultural' while bringing three lawyers.

- Long-running professional friendship and rivalry with Sue Venir.
- Frequently debates Dr. Art E. Fact and Robin Banks on how restitution should actually work.
- Artie Ficial has courted her support for several international partnerships.

ACTING TIPS

Elegant, diplomatic, strategic, warm until precision is required. You can disagree without ever sounding flustered.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Refined diplomatic formalwear; jewel tones, elegant suit or dress, subtle cultural or heritage-inspired accessory worn respectfully.

Elon Mosaic

Tech Founder, Collector & Museum Patron



Elon keeps suggesting that the museum should pivot to subscription antiquities. Elon made a fortune building software and has spent the last five years trying to become the sort of collector whose taste is discussed rather than merely his net worth.

- Buys through Hugh Bidder more often than either admits.
- Runs in the same social orbit as Tess Tament and Ella Gance.
- Drew Conclusions once described his collection as 'an algorithm discovering patina,' which Elon has not forgotten.

ACTING TIPS

Energetic, socially confident, competitive, eager to demonstrate taste without looking eager.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Modern black tie with tech-founder looseness: excellent jacket, minimal sneakers or polished shoes, unusual watch, bold glasses.

Anya Tique

Founding Curator Emerita



Anya remembers when the museum was two rooms and an argument. Anya helped build the Meridian's collection when the museum had more ambition than money and fewer committees than fire extinguishers.

- Hired Artie Ficial early in his career.
- Trusts Chip Patina and Anne E. Dote.
- Has known Tess Tament since Tess was a child.

ACTING TIPS

Imperious, funny, observant, utterly unimpressed by status. Age gives you permission to say what everyone else edits.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Old-school gala elegance: brooch, gloves, shawl, pearls, cane if desired, formal suit or dress with unmistakable presence.

Saul D. Bid

Chairman of Gavel & Rowe Auction House



Saul cannot ask someone to pass the salt without opening bidding. Saul has sold paintings, antiquities, estates, scandals, and at least one chair that required its own insurance rider.

- Longtime professional rival of Hugh Bidder.
- Knows Ella Gance and Elon Mosaic from the auction circuit.
- Anya Tique remembers when Saul was still carrying catalogues for someone else.

ACTING TIPS

Old-school charm, status-aware, patient, competitive. Speak as if the room has already agreed you belong in it.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Classic tuxedo or formal dark suit, silk pocket square, signet ring, reading glasses, optional miniature auction gavel.

Elle Loominate

Textile Artist & Designer



Elle has identified every fabric in the room, including the suspiciously shiny tuxedo. Elle turns weaving, embroidery, salvage fabric, and obsessive handwork into installations that critics call intimate and collectors call surprisingly difficult to ship.

- Has assisted Dada DiCapo on several installations.
- Friendly with Vincent Van Faux from the local art circuit.
- Chip Patina has advised her on displaying fragile textiles.

ACTING TIPS

Creative, grounded, quietly funny, detail-oriented. You notice what people wear and how things are made.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Formal outfit with texture: embroidered jacket, woven scarf, textile jewelry, patterned dress, unusual fabric.

Reed DeLabel

Doctoral Fellow in Art History



Reed reads every label aloud, including the exit sign. Reed is the youngest scholar attached to the exhibition and has been trying very hard to behave like this is normal.

- Doctoral student of Dr. Art E. Fact.
- Mentored informally by Claire O'Scuro.
- Anne E. Dote keeps rescuing Reed from conversations with donors who ask whether art history is a real degree.

ACTING TIPS

Eager, cerebral, anxious in a useful way, unexpectedly bold when the evidence is on your side.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Best-suit energy: formal but slightly less effortless than the veterans.

Al Baster

Sculptor & Public-Art Star



Al considers a pedestal a sculpture that has given up on itself. Al makes monumental sculpture in stone, steel, and whatever else can require a crane.

- Creative rival of Frank Lloyd Wrong after an argument about the entrance installation.
- Friendly competitor of Vincent Van Faux.
- Minnie Malist once designed a gala around one of Al's sculptures and still talks about the insurance.

ACTING TIPS

Big presence, playful arrogance, generous when admired, combative when minimized.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Bold formalwear, chunky ring, sculptural accessories, dark shirt with jacket, perhaps a dust-marked work boot paired with gala clothes.

Ella Gance

Collector, Style Patron & Society Fixture



Ella dresses as though the society pages arrive before the guests. Ella has excellent taste, excellent photographers, and excellent instincts about which artists will become impossible to buy next year.

- Collects work by Vincent Van Faux and Elle Loominate.
- Competes socially and at auction with Elon Mosaic.
- Uses Hugh Bidder when discretion matters and Saul D. Bid when spectacle does.

ACTING TIPS

Charming, strategic, stylish, lightly competitive. Compliments can be sincere and still accomplish something.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Fashion-forward gala look, statement jewelry, dramatic clutch, bold color or silhouette.

Drew Conclusions

Art Critic & Cultural Podcaster



Drew calls everything derivative, especially things he likes. Drew can make a museum director nervous with a headline and an artist furious with a compliment.

- Friendly rival of Paige Turner.
- Has reviewed Vincent Van Faux, Dada DiCapo, Al Baster, and Elle Loominate.
- Elon Mosaic remembers an especially brutal line about his collection.

ACTING TIPS

Dry, perceptive, skeptical, socially nimble. Deliver observations as if they occurred to you three minutes before everyone else.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Smart, artsy formalwear: black with one eccentric element, distinctive glasses, scarf, vintage jacket, notebook.

Brie DeVivre

Head Caterer & Hospitality Director



Brie has planned a cheese course more carefully than most people plan a wedding. Brie runs high-end events with the serene expression of a person mentally tracking forty-seven moving parts.

- Works closely with Minnie Malist and Monet Bags.
- Barb Dwyer has made Brie revise service routes repeatedly for security reasons.
- Artie Ficial trusts Brie to keep donors fed while everyone else panics.

ACTING TIPS

Competent, sociable, quietly authoritative, hard to rattle. You see the room from the service side.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Sharp black suit or upscale catering uniform, tie or bow tie, folded service towel, small order pad.

Cary Crates

Senior Art Handler & Installation Specialist



Cary knows which crate holds a masterpiece and which one holds the extension cords. Cary is the person trusted to move objects worth more than the building without dropping either.

- Works daily with Chip Patina.
- Has developed mutual respect with Frank Lloyd Wrong despite arguing about impossible installation drawings.
- Al Baster likes Cary because Cary actually knows how heavy sculpture is.

ACTING TIPS

Grounded, competent, laconic, surprisingly funny when you choose to speak.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Clean dark workwear dressed up for a gala: black trousers, sturdy shoes, smart shirt/jacket, work gloves tucked in pocket, measuring tape prop.

Anne E. Dote

Director of Education & Docent Programs



Anne can make a school group care about a pot shard. Tonight's donors are proving harder.

- Close to Anya Tique, who champions the education program.
- Often rescues Reed DeLabel from awkward public-facing moments.
- Works with Claire O'Scuro to translate scholarship into gallery interpretation.

ACTING TIPS

Engaging, practical, empathetic, irreverent about institutional pomp.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Colorful cocktail attire or polished museum-professional look, comfortable shoes, fun brooch or earrings, optional stack of tour cards.

Faye Stop

Gala Photographer & Editorial Portraitist



Faye will ask you to move half an inch until the end of time. Faye photographs artists, collectors, and public figures for magazines that describe parties like tonight as 'intimate' despite inviting two hundred people.

- Has photographed several investigations for Paige Turner.
- Dada DiCapo loves Faye's work because Faye does not overdirect.
- Ella Gance always knows which side Faye is shooting from.

ACTING TIPS

Observant, understated, curious, visually minded. You notice who is standing with whom and what happens at the edge of a room.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Elegant all-black or dark cocktail wear, camera as the key prop if available, comfortable shoes, press-style shoulder bag.

Robin Banks

Cultural Restitution Activist & Nonprofit Organizer



Robin has brought a petition, spare pens and absolutely no interest in donor etiquette. Robin campaigns for museums and collectors to return contested cultural objects, publish complete provenance, and stop treating possession as the end of the conversation.

- Frequently debates Dr. Art E. Fack and Mona Lott on strategy.
- Barb Dwyer has removed Robin from a museum event before; both remember it.
- Anne E. Dote quietly agrees with more of Robin's critique than museum leadership suspects.

ACTING TIPS

Focused, bold, principled, socially savvy. Challenge people without turning every conversation into a speech.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Smart gala attire with activist edge: bold pin, statement scarf, printed tote, elegant suit or dress.

Penny Pincher

Eccentric Private Collector



Penny is convinced that every museum object would look better in her hallway. Penny collects small paintings, strange decorative objects, and stories about who owned them before she did.

- Old friend of Anya Tique.
- Knows Saul D. Bid from decades of auctions.
- Ella Gance alternates between finding Penny inspiring and alarming.

ACTING TIPS

Eccentric, charming, nosy, unexpectedly shrewd. Ask questions that sound casual and are not.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Eclectic formalwear: vintage jewelry, dramatic brooches, velvet, patterned jacket, gloves, small opera glasses or fan.

Justin Tyme

Tulsa Arts Columnist & Local Historian



Justin remembers the previous scandal and has brought the clipping. Justin knows which gallery used to be a bank, which donor funded which wing, and which local art feud is still alive despite everyone involved pretending otherwise.

- Has profiled Artie Ficial and Anya Tique.
- Friendly with Anne E. Dote and Faye Stop.
- Paige Turner considers Justin useful when she needs Tulsa context and dangerous when he starts telling stories.

ACTING TIPS

Friendly, curious, locally knowledgeable, a little nosy. You connect people and remember old stories.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Cocktail suit or blazer, vintage Tulsa flair if desired, notebook, press card prop, old museum brochure tucked into pocket.

Minnie Malist

Gala Event Designer & Creative Producer



Minnie considers restrained lighting a cry for help. Minnie creates the visual spectacle around events like tonight: flowers, lighting, table styling, entrances, reveals, and the precise moment everyone is supposed to gasp.

- Works constantly with Frank Lloyd Wrong, who removes half of Minnie's ideas.
- Brie DeVivre is Minnie's favorite partner in event logistics.
- Monet Bags is the person who asks what Minnie's ideas cost.

ACTING TIPS

Energetic, aesthetic, affectionate, slightly chaotic but highly competent. You notice atmosphere first.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Creative formalwear: floral pin, velvet jacket, unusual bow tie, colorful suit, statement glasses.